

SambaNova Systems

AI Inference Infrastructure / Chips · Palo Alto, CA · Private (\$11B post-money; \$1B Series F first close 8 Jul 2026; >\$2B raised)

SambaNova - the sovereign AI-inference chipmaker fresh off a \$1B Series F at \$11B - has never been in F1, and on-prem real-time inference is a genuine (if crowded-lane) workstream for a team's pit-wall strategy and secure telemetry.

77

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Haas

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

SambaNova Systems, the Palo Alto AI-chip company, completed the first close of a \$1B Series F at an \$11B valuation (8 Jul 2026), led by General Atlantic with T. Rowe Price, Capital Group, Intel Capital, Vista Equity, BlackRock and QIA; JPMorgan named SambaNova an on-premise inference-infrastructure partner the same day, and CEO Rodrigo Liang is publicly weighing a 2027 IPO. Total funding is now above \$2B. It has never touched motorsport. IMPORTANT (desk honesty): this prospect came from an external 1440 intelligence brief that scored it 87 (HOT TOP TIER) and recommended Cadillac - but that duplicates our Cerebras signal (07-03), which already holds the AI-compute recommendation at Cadillac; Cerebras and SambaNova are direct competitors for one slot, and Cerebras (public, ~\$67B, profitable) is the stronger of the two. So this is re-scored honestly to 77 and re-pointed to Haas, on a genuinely distinct angle: SambaNova's edge is sovereign, on-premise, low-latency INFERENCE - which maps to a team's real-time pit-wall race-strategy computation and secure trackside telemetry, distinct from Cerebras's factory-CFD training compute. HONEST framing: it is compute infrastructure (off-car), F1's AI lane is crowded, and the round is a first close - scored accordingly. Verified decision-maker: CEO & Co-Founder Rodrigo Liang.

WHY NOW

The Series F first close (8 Jul) and the on-the-record IPO signal put SambaNova in a brand-build moment, and the US GP (Austin, Oct 2026) plus Las Vegas GP are natural anchors for its funded US go-to-market. The honest why-now is catalyst- and IPO-window-driven (Cerebras's debut set the benchmark), not a dated F1 trigger.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$11B

Series F first close (8 Jul 2026; General Atlantic-led; second close pending)

\$1B

Round size (first close) / total funding now above \$2B

JPMorgan

JPMorgan named SambaNova an on-prem inference-infrastructure partner (SN40L/SN50)

Rodrigo Liang

CEO & Co-Founder; strongly considering a 2027 IPO

+68% day 1

Benchmark it is watching: Cerebras Nasdaq debut

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Haas	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Red Bull Racing	CROWDED	Oracle
McLaren	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

The sovereign/on-prem AI-INFERENCE chipmaker: \$1B Series F first close at \$11B (8 Jul 2026, General Atlantic-led; JPMorgan named it an inference-infrastructure partner the same day; >\$2B raised; CEO Rodrigo Liang eyeing a 2027 IPO). Sourced from an external 1440 brief - facts verified live (accurate), BUT that brief scored it 87/TOP-TIER and put it at Cadillac, which DUPLICATES our Cerebras signal (07-03, same AI-compute category + team). Corrected: honest 77 HOT and re-pointed to Haas, on a distinct REAL-TIME INFERENCE angle (trackside race-strategy + on-prem secure telemetry) vs Cerebras's factory-CFD training compute. Deal-capable, fresh, but AI infra is crowded on the grid.

WHY HAAS

Haas is the American privateer that runs lean and lives on smart real-time strategy, so on-prem, low-latency inference (fast, secure race-strategy and telemetry AI) is a genuine fit, and the American-sovereign-AI story lands on a US team - without duplicating our Cerebras-at-Cadillac AI-compute recommendation. Haas's AI-compute lane is open (Mphasis is a services integrator, not a chip/compute-infrastructure product). Cadillac was the external brief's pick but is taken in our book by Cerebras (same category); re-pointing avoids double-pitching one team two rival AI-chip firms.

VALUE TO HAAS — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

A TWO-WAY exchange (tech + business both directions), not a logo fee - three concrete swaps. (1) ON-PREM INFERENCE <-> REAL-TIME PROVING GROUND: SambaNova powers the team's low-latency pit-wall race-strategy inference and secure on-prem telemetry AI (the sovereign JPMorgan use case, transferred to the garage); the team gives SambaNova the ultimate real-time, high-stakes inference showcase. (2) CO-ENGINEERED INFERENCE WORKLOADS <-> PRODUCT VALIDATION: jointly tuning race-strategy and telemetry inference on SambaNova's stack advances its edge/on-prem reference; the team gets a faster, sharper real-time decision edge for a lean budget. (3) US IPO STAGE + BUYERS <-> ENGINEERING CREDIBILITY: SambaNova (pre-IPO, American-sovereign) gets the US-race institutional-investor visibility (Austin/Vegas) it wants ahead of 2027, and the paddock's enterprise ecosystem is its buyer base; the team gets a well-funded frontier-AI partner and an innovation story. Haas gets a real-time inference edge + a funded partner; SambaNova gets a showcase, buyers and an IPO stage.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official AI Inference / Compute Partner on Haas, minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr with an IPO-trigger scale-up clause, structured as an on-prem inference workstream (real-time race-strategy + secure telemetry) plus US-race brand activation - value exchanged both ways, not a pure livery fee.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Rodrigo Liang
CEO & CO-FOUNDER, SAMBANOVA SYSTEMS - VERIFIED

Co-founder and CEO of SambaNova (Stanford-trained; led every round A through F), the owner of brand and strategic-partnership decisions and the entry point - for whom a US institutional-investor stage ahead of a 2027 IPO plus enterprise-buyer access is strategically valuable. Confirm the marketing/partnerships lead before outreach.

OPENING ANGLE

"Rodrigo - you just closed a \$1B Series F with an IPO clock running, and F1's US races are where AI-infrastructure names build institutional credibility. Haas is American, lean and lives on real-time strategy - your sovereign on-prem inference is their pit-wall edge and your stage. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 \$1B Series F first close at \$11B (8 Jul 2026) with an IPO (2027) signal on the record - a live, this-month capital + identity inflection. (External brief said 19; honest 17 - it's a first close, not a closed round/ IPO.)	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$11B post-money and >\$2B raised - amply deal-capable at a value-to-mid tier. (External brief said 20/20; honest 18 - deal-capable, but not the largest in the set and pre-IPO.)	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 Sovereign/on-prem AI inference is on-message and the American-sovereign story fits a US team - but it is compute infrastructure, not performance-visible, and F1's AI lane is heavily crowded, so this is a distinct inference sub-lane on an open team, not a 20/20 slam-dunk. (External brief said 20/20; honest 14.)	URGENCY 13 / 20 The IPO clock (Cerebras's +68% debut is the benchmark) creates a real window, but there is no dated F1 trigger.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: on-prem inference genuinely fits a team's real-time race-strategy computation and secure telemetry inference (the JPMorgan on-prem use case, transferred to the pit wall) - a real workstream, distinct from factory-CFD training compute, honestly bounded.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

DUPLICATES OUR CEREBRAS SIGNAL (CATEGORY) SambaNova and Cerebras are both AI-compute names; the external brief put both-style pitch at Cadillac. **Counter:** Re-pointed to Haas on a distinct real-time-inference angle; if the desk runs only one AI-compute name, Cerebras (public, ~\$67B, profitable) is the stronger pick - treat SambaNova as the inference-specific / second option.

COMPUTE INFRA, OFF-CAR + CROWDED AI LANE It is infrastructure, not performance-visible, and F1's AI lane is heavily contested. **Counter:** Score honestly (MODE-A-operational, 77 - not the external brief's inflated 87) and position precisely in the sovereign on-prem inference sub-lane on an open team.

FIRST CLOSE / PRE-IPO The \$1B is a first close (second close pending) and the IPO is a 2027 possibility, not certain. **Counter:** Structure with milestone/IPO-trigger payments; even at first close (>\$2B raised, \$11B) it is amply deal-capable.

SOURCES

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